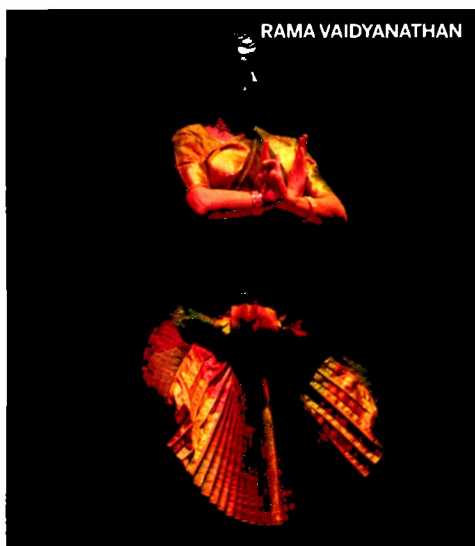




MUSIC FESTIVAL

Divine BEATS

Music is a medium when the atma and parmatma meet. It is a rare experience," said Siddheshwari Devi. In India, devotional music has been an intrinsic part of daily life be it the *azaan*, bhajans, chanting at the ghats, the shabad or a sadhu singing a Sufi song. Bringing all this to Delhi is the Sacred Arts Festival from February 13 to 25. The line-up is a variety of dance and music to choose from—Jewish Sacred Music, Buddhist Chants at Ladaki Buddha Vihar, Sufi qawwali at Nizamuddin Dargah, hymns of Guru Gobind Singh at Dumdama Sahib Gurdwara and nirgun and shagun bhajans by Madhup Mudgal. To show the spiritual aspect of movement, Bharatanatyam dancer Rama Vaidyanathan will be performing 'In Search of Dance' and 'Dancing to the Gods and Raasilila' by artistes from the Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Academy. For Sufi and choir lovers, there will be a trance performed by the Alkindi Ensemble from Syria and choir music by Cosmic Voices from Bulgaria. Apart from performances there are interesting lectures, workshops and a film festival as well. This is the place to find your intellectual space.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

THEATRE FESTIVAL Stagecraft Honours

The Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Awards, possibly the only festival in India which bestows cash awards on theatre productions, will host its annual festival from February 28 to March 5 at the Kamani Auditorium and the Sri Ram Centre. The festival features famous plays in many languages—Malayalam, French, English, Urdu, Hindi and Assamese. *Hamlet-The Clown Prince*, directed by Rajat Kapoor, is among this list of possible winners.

by Nirmala Ravindran



MERE KHWABON MEIN JO AAYE

Quite a Nightmare

Director: Madhureeta Anand

Starring: Randeep Hooda, Raima Sen



Two things strike you within the first few minutes of the movie. How can a woman director have such gay fantasies? Why does Hooda speak so watching-water-boil-on-the-stove slowly? I have no dispute with the subject of the film. Female empowerment, woman leaves bad marriage to discover herself, does a little hanky panky on the side with a dream man who appears in 18 different avatars, ends up becoming a rock star. Great idea. But there are only so many times we can watch Hooda changing his clothes, sometimes Elvis Presley, another time Zorro, and yet another time Shahjahan. Especially because his impressively waxed chest does get in the way. Sen is all big eyes and breathlessness. And really, Arbaaz Khan must stop playing the cuckolding husband. Immediately. Women-oriented stories are so rarely filmed so it's a pity when one that gets made turns out to be so tepid. Where's the spirit, girls?

Wake up. by Kaveree Bamzai

RATING ★☆☆☆☆